

You Have 4 Months Left! EP 328

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Executive Summary

Brandon Carter makes the case that the final 120 days of 2026 are enough to dramatically change your body and income — if you replace vague motivation with math, leading indicators, calendar blocking, and environment design instead of waiting for January 1.

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Introduction & Context 0:59

- Host introduces himself as **Big Brandon Carter** (also "King Keo," "Gymnasium Jesus"), recording Episode 328 of the Victory Talk Podcast
- Claims to have made over **\$20 million online** and run several multi-million dollar businesses
- Co-host/chat moderator: DJ Chaita Grande (monitoring live chat)
- Upcoming promo: Free live training **Sunday at 7:00 PM EST** on growing an online fitness business using AI
 - Goal: teach viewers to make an extra **\$300–\$500/day** as an online trainer
 - Will give away AI tools for content editing, content ideation, and client outreach
- Satirical sponsor bit: "Dot Repellent" — a running joke product

Why January 1st Is a Lie 1:05

- There are roughly **120 days / 4 months** left in 2026 as of recording
- Millions of people have already mentally quit and plan to coast through September, October, November, December
 - Pattern: October gets busy → Thanksgiving → Christmas → New Year's resolution
- January 1st is an **arbitrary date** — nothing magical changes
 - "You're not going to wake up on January 1st with more discipline. Your metabolism isn't going to change."
 - Procrastination disguised as planning: "I'll start Monday / next month / after vacation / January 1"
- Two versions of you on January 1:
 - **Version A (coasted)**: Same or worse — likely 10–15 lbs heavier due to holiday weight gain (average American gains 10–15 lbs over holidays)
 - **Version B (locked in)**: 15 lbs leaner, business making extra \$5–10K/month, 100+ pieces of content published, habits built
- "The time is going to pass either way, brother."
- Reframe: don't think "I only have four months" — think ***"I have four months. Let's get after it."

The most dangerous habit you can build is teaching yourself that you need some special magical day before you're allowed to change.

Step 1: Turn Your Goal Into Math 1:42

- Pick **one target** (two at most) — not 30 things
 - Ask: "If I accomplished one thing between now and December 31st, what would make me say this year counted?"
- A goal without math behind it is just a wish
- **For fat loss:**
 - Calories: body weight in lbs × 10 = daily calorie target
 - Reasoning: aggressive deficit is necessary because FDA allows food labels to be off by **20%**, making small deficits (200–500 cal) easy to accidentally erase
 - "Eating intuitively" is dismissed — tracking is non-negotiable
 - Protein: **1 gram per pound of body weight**
 - Higher protein preserves muscle on an aggressive deficit
 - Thermogenic effect of protein: **20–30%** of protein calories are burned in digestion vs. ~10–15% for carbs and ~3% for fat
 - Practical result: eat 100 calories of protein → body only absorbs ~70–80 calories net
 - Even at 300 lbs (300g protein), this is valid — less than 2% of the global population is 300 lbs
 - Steps: **20,000 steps per day**

- How to hit it:
 - 30-minute walk immediately upon waking
 - 30-minute walk after lunch
 - 60-minute walk after work
 - 10-minute walk every hour during the workday
- **For income (e.g., \$20K/month goal):**
 - If average sale = \$1,000 → need **20 sales/month**
 - Work backwards: how many appointments to close 20 sales? How many leads to get those appointments?
 - Keep breaking the goal down until it's pure math
- **For content/audience growth:**
 - Decide: 1 video/day? 5/week? Give it a number
 - Instagram CEO confirmed: the more you post, the faster you grow
- Case study — **Corey Armstrong** (High Ticket Trainer community member):
 - Struggled to hit \$10K/month for a long time
 - Brandon put him on an aggressive fitness protocol (20K steps/day + diet)
 - Got lean, then business took off
 - Result: **\$40K in one month**, finished the year at **\$470,000**



Step 2: Obsess Over Leading Indicators, Not Lagging Ones [1:49](#)

- **Lagging indicators** = outcomes you can't directly control (scale weight, bank balance, follower count, revenue, views) — they just show what already happened
- **Leading indicators** = the daily actions that create those outcomes
- Fat loss leading indicators: calories consumed, protein hit, calories burned, steps taken, workouts completed
 - Math: burn 500 cal/day more than you consume = **1 lb fat lost per week** ($500 \times 7 = 3,500 \text{ cal} = 1 \text{ lb}$)
 - 1,000 cal/day deficit = **2 lbs fat lost per week**
- Business leading indicators: outreach attempts per day, appointments booked, sales calls taken
- Content leading indicators: scripts written, videos filmed, videos posted
- Make it a **scoreboard** — write it down or track it; every day you either hit the numbers or you didn't
- Eliminates the lie of "I've been working really hard"
 - Example: student says "I'm posting a lot" → turns out it's twice a week → "You got exactly what you were supposed to get"
 - Top earners in Brandon's community post **5 reels a day**
- "Men lie, women lie, but numbers don't."
- Case study — **Jen Caesar** (High Ticket Trainer community member):

- Full-time nurse practitioner, two young boys, husband — extremely busy
- Committed to posting **4–5 videos every single day**
- April result: **\$49,927** (one day short of \$50K)
- May (partial): **\$12,577** already partway through the month



Step 3: Your Calendar Is the Cheat Code 1:49

- There are **168 hours in every week** — everyone gets the same amount
- "If you're serious about your goals, time is your number one weapon. The calendar is the cheat code."
- **Plan every single hour of every day** in your calendar
 - Include: sleep, job, family obligations, workouts, content creation, business blocks
 - Then show what's left — most people don't have a time problem, they have a **time allocation problem**
- Common time wasters to identify: 2 hrs Netflix, 90 min Instagram scrolling, random phone usage
 - "Look at the screen time on your phone. I bet we can find some hours every day."
- Be specific — don't say "I'll work on my business this week"
 - Say: "Content creation 6:00–8:00 AM" or "Saturday morning: reviewing analytics and planning next batch"
 - If 9-to-5 worker: work on business **7–9 AM** before the job
- "If you say something's important to you and it's not in your calendar, you're probably not really committed to it. You might be interested, but you ain't committed."
- Promised outcome: do this for four months and you'll accomplish more than you probably have in the last few years



Step 4: Win One Week at a Time 1:57

- Don't wake up thinking about the entire 120-day mountain — think about **today**
- Each week, pick your **Big Three**: the three things you actually need to accomplish to make the week a success
 - Protect those three time blocks — they're the priority
- Stack the wins:
 - Win the day → win the week (7 good days)
 - Stack 4 good weeks → good month
 - Stack 4 good months → the year is transformed
- People around you will assume you joined the Illuminati because your life changed so dramatically



Step 5: Create the Floor (No Zero Day Rule) 1:09

- Bad days will happen: travel, poor sleep, family emergencies, social invitations
- Before a bad day hits, **pre-decide your minimum acceptable standard**

Normal Standard	Minimum on a Bad Day
20,000 steps	10,000 steps
3-hour work block	30 minutes
20 outreach attempts	10 outreach attempts

- The minimum isn't optimal — it exists so one bad day doesn't become three, then a week, then a month
- Pattern to avoid: miss one day → "this week is shot, I'll restart Monday" → Monday becomes next month → next month becomes next year
- "Your goal is not perfection. The goal is to make quitting difficult."
- Always do *something* — getting out of the habit is the real danger; restarting is the hardest part

Step 6: Design Your Environment for Success 1:34

- Don't fight willpower battles every day — engineer the environment so good decisions are the default
- Core concept: **friction**
 - Amazon makes subscribing easy, canceling hard — that's intentional friction design
 - Apply the same logic to your own behaviors
- **Increase friction** on bad behaviors:
 - Remove junk food from your house entirely — if ice cream isn't there, you'd have to order it via Uber Eats/Instacart (friction = less likely to do it)
 - Put your phone in another room or lock it in the bathroom during deep work blocks
 - Don't schedule workouts at 7 PM if you're always exhausted by then — move them to morning
 - Distance yourself from people who pull you away from your goals
- **Decrease friction** on good behaviors:
 - Brandon's morning routine example:
 - Phone alarm on the other side of the room → forces getting out of bed
 - Robe hanging by the door → easy to grab
 - Gucci slides right there → slip on immediately
 - Pre-made preworkout sitting on the desk → chug immediately upon sitting down
 - Whatever he needs to work on is already open on the computer from the night before
 - Result: **working within 5 minutes of waking up**
- "Discipline is important, but what's even better is not putting yourself in situations where you need discipline."

Step 7: Weekly Scoreboard Review 1:40

- Every **7 days**, sit down and review:
 - What did I actually do?

- What numbers/metrics did I hit?
- What did I miss, and why?
- What will I change next week to improve?
- Keep it analytical — not emotional, not a therapy session; the week is just a scoreboard
- **Never adjust the goal — only adjust the plan/route**
 - Analogy: D-Day planners had a Plan B, but Plan B wasn't "live with the Nazis" — it was a different strategy toward the same goal
- The 120-day period = one giant feedback loop: **execute** → **measure** → **adjust** → **execute again**
- Competitive advantage: gyms pack in January, but empty out by December — September through December is when competitors quit, which is your opportunity to pull ahead
- "When everybody else slows down, you should be speeding up."
- By January 1, you'll be on **Day 121** with momentum, built habits, and proven systems — while everyone else is on Day 1

Confidence isn't standing in the mirror telling yourself you're a winner. Confidence is having evidence that when you tell yourself you're going to do something, you actually do it.

Market Update with Greg 1:03

- Guest: **Greg** (regular market analyst on the podcast)
- S&P 500 had a "gap and go" day — opened higher, squeezed higher, up **1%** (vs. typical 0.2–0.4%)
 - Caution: gap-and-go moves can reverse as soon as the next day
 - Volume extremely low: average ~122M shares/day this year, but recent weeks only ~37M (25% of normal) — making price action less meaningful
 - Greg uses a **Claude AI prompt** to predict S&P closing price; 17 predictions made, average miss ~13 points; dead-on days can yield 10x returns on options
 - Example: \$30 call option → \$1,700 (3,000% move on one gap day)
- Macro outlook: **leaning bullish**; market likely to break out; watch SPY 760 as breakdown level; potential all-time highs by end of month; 5% upside target for S&P into year-end (already up 2% of that)
- **Nvidia (NVDA)**: Ascending triangle, bullish; fair value ~\$310–\$315, currently ~\$228 → ~37–40% upside; Greg and Brandon both bullish
- **PayPal (PYPL)**: Fair value \$80, currently ~\$57; Michael Burr bought in the \$40s (popped to \$60s); Greg bought calls + 20 shares
 - Trade idea discussed: November \$57.5/\$62.5 call spread — risk ~\$186 to potentially turn into ~\$500
 - Longer-term idea: Buy Dec 2027 \$60 call / sell \$80 call — risk ~\$580 to turn into ~\$2,000
 - Pays 1% dividend; next resistance ~8% higher from ~\$53–54
- **Copper**: Still bullish; Greg holds 2028 calls; Brandon holds Jan 2027 calls; key breakout level \$41; target ~\$45 by year-end; up ~17% on the year

- **Gold:** Greg bought yesterday, took profits; still looks good for longs on any dip
- **NBIS:** Called at \$90, now at \$210 (hit highs of \$300)
- **Apple (AAPL):** Called after earnings gap-down; grinding toward \$334 price target; spread buyers near ~100% gain
- **Google (GOOGL):** Still has significant upside; Greg prefers Google + Nvidia as a pair trade over SpaceX
- **SpaceX:** Greg likes Dec 15, 2028 \$175/\$180 call spread — risk \$160 to turn into \$500; needs only 10% upside over ~3 years; Brandon doesn't like the fundamentals
- **Japan (EWJ):** About to break out to all-time highs; shares with stop at 94; not very liquid for options
- **Emerging Markets (EM):** Break above 68 looks good; price alert suggested
- **Honeywell (HON):** Fair value \$360, currently ~\$207 (~100% upside); but price trend is weak, sellers in control; split into two companies; not actionable yet
- **MSTR (MicroStrategy/Strategy):** Discussed per super chat; free cash flow -\$22B, net income -\$3.8B, revenue ~\$47M; 20% below 52-week high; Brandon and Greg both pass on it despite bullish price action — "momentum stock" vs. value investor debate
- **AI trading tools comparison:** Brandon wants to test **Gemini 3.8 Flash** vs. Claude Opus for S&P predictions
 - Gemini Flash pricing: input \$0.75/1M tokens vs. Claude Opus \$5/1M; output \$3.73/1M vs. Opus \$25/1M
 - Gemini scored higher on financial analyst benchmarks than Anthropic's top models
 - Plan: run both AIs daily, post predicted closing price, potentially average the two predictions for iron condor/butterfly setups
- **Victory Trades** community results shown: member wins including \$400, \$532, \$386 from Claude prompt trades; 170% gain (\$50 → \$135); 300% gain (\$50 → \$200 butterfly); 1.1K from Apple calls
 - Funded accounts available starting as low as \$16–\$30 via Apex Trader Funding
 - Live trading room, trade alerts, voice channel for community trading

Super Chat Q&A 1:21

- **Kinfolk** — "Men being hostile because you're muscular and stand out":
 - Brandon: doesn't care what people think; would just roast them back; treats it as a compliment ("they're mad because your girl's hot")
 - "It's more disciplined to be muscular than to be basic. Laugh it off and do more sets."
- **Rayford** — Samsung ZFold 8 vs. iPhone:
 - Brandon owns a Samsung S-series, two iPhones, multiple PCs, and Macs — "I don't live a life of scarcity"
 - Main phone is iPhone; no issues with Samsung phones, only Samsung watches (running joke)
- **Go Fast Die Last** — "With 4 hours/day, what income is realistic (\$100K–\$500K)":
 - 4 hours/day of deep work = hard to fail at building a side income
 - Brandon's recommendation: **online fitness training** (his personal superpower/bias)
 - Notes that any advisor will recommend their own superpower

- **Aiden** — Adderall advice (prescribed, scared of addiction, wants to make \$100K fast):
 - Brandon: consult your doctor for everything; not giving medical advice
 - Personal anecdote: used Adderall for ~18 months consecutively while building income; got off it once financially stable; experienced 2–3 weeks of withdrawal (fatigue, depression)
 - Reframed the withdrawal mentally: "This is not real life. I just have to keep repeating that."
 - His take: get rich first, then handle the addiction
- **Nigel** — One-on-one mentorship with Brandon:
 - Available but expensive: **~\$20,000 for 12 weeks**
 - DM on Instagram if serious; depends on what income stream you want to pursue
- **Alex** — Overcame impostor syndrome by making calls and working with real clients:
 - Brandon celebrates this: "Let's go! That's how you do it."
- **Pylor** — Quit a 30-hr/week low-paying unrelated job to focus on a well-paying 30-hr/week software job:
 - Brandon says that's the right move; focus on upskilling in the software role; "this industry is moving too fast to take your foot off the gas"

AI Tools, Victory Trades & Closing Promotions 1:08

- **Free Live Training — this Sunday, 7:00 PM EST:**
 - How to grow an online fitness business using AI
 - Goal: walk away able to make \$300–\$500/day as an online trainer
 - Free AI tools provided: content editing, content ideation, scripting, client outreach
 - Register via link in description
- **High Ticket Trainer:** Brandon's program teaching trainers to grow online fitness businesses — how he made his first million
- **Victory Trades (Discord community):**
 - Daily trade alerts sent to phone
 - Live futures trading every morning
 - Claude (and soon Gemini) AI price predictions posted daily
 - Funded accounts via Apex Trader Funding starting at **\$16**
 - Voice channel for community trading even when hosts aren't live
 - Greg transitioning away from public appearances (starting a hedge fund in ~3 years; regulatory requirements); Victory Trades will continue
- Podcast schedule: **every Tuesday and Thursday at 7:00 PM EST**
- Closing call to action: start today, not January 1 — stack 120 days of evidence that you're the person who does what they say they'll do